Map

Five steps with guiding questions to help you understand and analyze the primary source

1 **Identify the Source**	Who created this map?
	What kind of map is it? Topographic, political, military, economic, population, satellite, or something else?
2 **Place the Source in Context**	What's the historical context of this map?
	When was the map made, and what time or era does the map show?
3 **Analyze the Source Content**	What does this map show?
	Does the map include a legend or guide?
	What facts does the map include?
	Does this map have a particular subject?
	Does the map show a change over time or differences among regions?
4 **Assess the Source Perspective**	Does the data in the map suggest certain conclusions?
	Does this map directly or indirectly have a specific point or perspective?
	Does the map support or contradict your own conclusions?
	Do you think the map is accurate?
	Does the map include everything you would like to see? What do you think might make it better?
5 **Evaluate the Source**	Do you think this map is an important one? Why do you think it was created?
	What conclusions does this map lead you to make?
	What connections can you make from this map to politics, issues, culture and society, faith and religion, historical change over time, etc.?
	Does comparing this map with other sources, past or present, provide valuable insight?
	Can you tie this map into key themes, questions, controversies, and debates? How can you tie this map into questions you have?